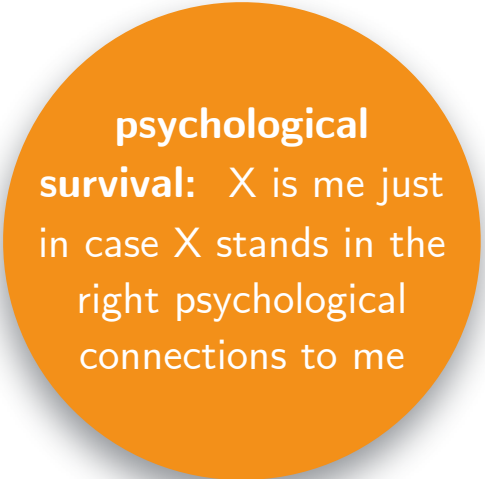


Is life after
death
possible?

Matters are less clear when it comes to our other answers
to the survival question.

A large orange circle with a soft drop shadow, containing white text.

psychological
survival: X is me just
in case X stands in the
right psychological
connections to me

soul survival:

X is me just in case

X is the same

immaterial soul as

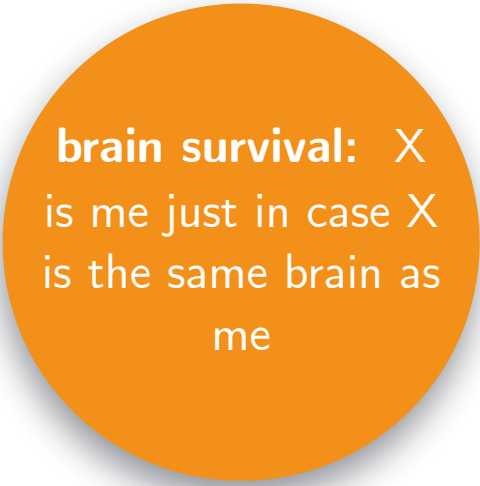
me

organism

survival: X is me
just in case X is the
same organism as
me

combination

survival: X is me
just in case X is the
combination of my
soul and my body

A large, solid orange circle is centered on a white background. Inside the circle, the text "brain survival: X is me just in case X is the same brain as me" is written in white, sans-serif font. The text is arranged in four lines, centered horizontally.

brain survival: X
is me just in case X
is the same brain as
me

These views differ in important ways, but they all agree that your survival depends on the survival of a certain physical thing.

Views of this kind face an obvious problem in making sense of the possibility of life after death. After death bodies decay (or are cremated). Doesn't that just show that the relevant physical objects won't survive your death — and so that, if one of the above views is right, you won't?

This is a problem which has long troubled philosophers in
the Christian tradition.

This might sound surprising. After all, don't Christians believe that one's immaterial soul is enough for life after death?

In fact, this is not the traditional Christian view. The following quote from Aquinas is representative:

Is life after
death
possible?

to the survival question.

Matters are less clear when it comes to whether answers

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in case X stands in the
right psychological
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brain survival: X
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physical things.

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